

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/25: Official boundary and the two-axis control

SYLLABUS: Analogical and Symbolic; Cognitivist and Non-cognitive.

CENTRAL QUESTION: how can finite language refer to transcendence, and what does it claim?

HOW / SEMANTIC MODE: univocal | analogy | symbol | negation | indication

WHETHER / STATUS: cognitive | mixed | moral-conative | blik | use | meaningless

CONTROL: "God is good" may be ANALOGICAL in mode and COGNITIVE in intent.

Meaningfulness does not entail empirical factuality; performance does not cancel assertion.

FIREWALL: experience, revelation, pluralism and full school doctrines retain their owners.

LITERAL / UNIVOCAL -> same conceptual sense; cognitive; anthropomorphism risk.
ANALOGICAL -> ordered similarity through causal participation or proportion.
METAPHORICAL -> imaginative transfer; may disclose indirectly.
SYMBOLIC -> participation + disclosure + transformation; truth-status depends on theory.
MYTHIC -> narrative organisation of world, identity and value.
NEGATIVE / APOPHATIC -> deny creaturely limits; vacuity risk.
PERFORMATIVE -> vow, blessing, confession or relation enacted under success-conditions.
EXPRESSIVE / PRESCRIPTIVE -> attitude or conduct; non-cognitive need not be meaningless.
ONE UTTERANCE can combine assertion, symbol, expression and commitment.

UNIVOCITY

gain: valid inference and stable concept

cost: God appears as a finite member of a shared category

EQUIVOCITY

gain: radical transcendence

cost: no intelligible reference; inference equivocates

CLASSICAL EXITS

Aquinas -> analogy

Tillich -> participatory symbol

Maimonides / apophasis -> negation

Scotus -> semantic univocity + finite/infinite intrinsic modes

EXAM LINE: preserve enough continuity for reference and enough difference for transcendence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/25: Aquinas: essential and eminent predication

SOURCE: Summa Theologiae I q.13.

PURE PERFECTION (goodness, wisdom) exists in God ESSENTIALLY AND EMINENTLY.

thing signified (res significata) -> applies truly to God

mode of signification (modus significandi) -> creature-derived and inadequate

CAUSAL PARTICIPATION

effect resembles cause without possessing perfection in the same finite mode

AQUINAS REJECTS cause-only paraphrase:

not merely "God causes goodness"; God causes goodness because God is good.

GAIN: cognitive realism without crude literalism.

COST: how is analogical content fixed without prior knowledge of God?

ATTRIBUTION

"healthy" primarily of animal; medicine as cause; complexion as sign
ordered secondary use -> illustrates relation, not whole divine goodness doctrine

PROPORTIONALITY

God has goodness according to infinite mode
creature has goodness according to finite mode

HISTORICAL CONTROL

familiar pair = later Thomist, especially Cajetanian, systematisation
do not present as Aquinas's unqualified fixed taxonomy

ENGINE remains causal participation + pure perfection.

TRAP: analogy is not metaphor, equivocation or cause-only naming.

CERTAIN/DOUBTFUL ARGUMENT

 certain: God is a being

 doubtful: finite or infinite?

 therefore "being" is a concept neutral/common before modal specification

UNIVOCITY IS SEMANTIC, NOT ONTOLOGICAL.

 being is not a genus containing God and creatures

 finite / infinite intrinsic modes restore the ontological gulf

DUNS SCOTUS'S OBJECTION: analogy without common concept collapses into equivocation.

THOMIST REPLY: causal relation supplies ordered continuity.

TRADE-OFF: inference gained; anthropomorphism / onto-theology charge remains contested.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/25: Maimonides and negative theology

SOURCE: Guide for the Perplexed I.50–60.

POSITIVE ESSENTIAL ATTRIBUTES -> threaten divine simplicity -> rejected.

PERMITTED SPEECH

- negations: God is not ignorant / not powerless

- attributes of action: called merciful from effects, not creature-like emotion

GAIN: protects transcendence and removes false models.

COST: unlimited negation risks VACUITY and cannot distinguish God from nothing.

ANSWER CONTROL: negative content is determinate exclusion, not empty silence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/25: Tillich: symbol and being-itself

SIGN -> conventional pointer; replaceable; does not participate.

SYMBOL -> points + PARTICIPATES + opens reality/self + transforms.

arises collectively; grows and may die

GOD -> not one being or highest being; symbolically disclosed as BEING-ITSELF.

FAILURE

finite bearer claims ultimacy -> IDOLATRY / DEMONIC distortion

unconstrained participation -> vague or circular reference

CAUTION

"God is being-itself" proposed as non-symbolic anchor

Tillich later modified it; interpretive status remains disputed.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/25: Ramsey, metaphor and myth

IAN RAMSEY: ordinary MODEL + QUALIFIER -> disclosure situation ("penny drops")

father + heavenly | cause + first | good + infinitely

qualifier stretches and corrects; it does not erase ordinary content

METAPHOR -> transfers a pattern imaginatively without literal identity

MYTH -> narrative organises identity, world and value

DISTINCTIONS

metaphor / myth are not identical to Tillichian participation

disclosure is not proof; public and doctrinal constraints remain necessary

PAYOFF: religious language is a stretched use of a common instrument.

J. L. AUSTIN

locutionary content -> what words/proposition say

illocutionary force -> act performed

perlocutionary effect -> consequence for hearer/community

EXAMPLES: "I take refuge" | baptism | vow | blessing | ritual resolve (saṃkalpa)

DONALD EVANS: SELF-INVOLVING speech commits speaker and constitutes relationship.

CONTROL

performative force does not cancel cognitive presuppositions

one proposition may be asserted, confessed, promised or recited ironically

TRAP: do not test every religious utterance only as detached description.

DIFFERENCE IS FUNCTIONAL, NOT LEXICAL.		
AXIS	SECULAR CENTRE	RELIGIOUS CENTRE
function	describe/predict	worship/confess/bless/vow
reference	empirical particulars	transcendent / non-ostensible
verification	determinate procedures	contested/experiential/eschatological
logic/register	ordinary public use	symbol, paradox, liturgy, mantra
self-involvement	often detachable	characteristically committing
CONTINUITY		
same words, ordinary logic and overlapping speech acts		
secular oath can be performative; scripture can contain ordinary factual claims.		

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/25: Ayer and verification

A. J. AYER: synthetic factual meaning requires possible experiential confirmation.
 strong verification -> conclusive (too strict)
 weak verification -> probabilistic support still required
"God exists" -> no experience bears on it -> literally meaningless, not merely false.
OBJECTIONS
 verification principle appears neither analytic nor empirically verified
 excludes many historical, theoretical, ethical and modal claims
LESSON
 evidence matters, but empirical testability cannot simply equal all meaning.
NEXT MOVE: falsification asks what would count AGAINST the assertion.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 13/25: Flew, Hare, Mitchell and Hick

ANTONY FLEW / invisible gardener

endless qualifications -> claim "dies" if nothing counts against it

R. M. HARE / paranoid student

blik = non-factual world-orientation; important without hypothesis-status

BASIL MITCHELL / partisan and Stranger

defeasible trust; adverse evidence genuinely counts but may be outweighed

JOHN HICK / celestial city

truth-apt now; eschatological verification at journey's end

CONTROL

Hare != Mitchell; Hick != present verification; resilient faith != immunity.

KEY TEST: what evidence changes warrant, interpretation or commitment?

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 14/25: The ten-point cognitive spectrum

1 strong literal realism -> Alston / Swinburne
2 analogical realism -> Aquinas
3 symbolic realism -> Tillich / Ramsey
4 eschatological realism -> Hick
5 mixed speech act -> Evans / Alston
6 meaning-in-use -> Wittgensteinian / Phillips [classification disputed]
7 moral-conative -> Braithwaite
8 attitudinal blik -> Hare
9 fictionalism / non-realism -> Cupitt / Le Poidevin
10 hostile elimination -> Ayer
VERDICT: spectrum, not binary; locate truth-aptness, reference and primary force.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 15/25: Braithwaite: moral policy and stories

R. B. BRAITHWAITE, An Empiricist's View of the Nature of Religious Belief (1955).

"GOD IS LOVE" -> avowal of AGAPEISTIC MORAL POLICY.

STORIES -> exemplary patterns + motivation; practical seriousness preserved.

GAIN

creed/conduct link; self-involvement; religion not meaningless

COST

believers intend realist reference too

secular agape possible without theology

prayer, lament, creation and resurrection are not one moral policy

VERDICT: valuable pragmatics; reductionist as total semantics.

LUDWIG WITTGENSTEIN'S LECTURES

Last Judgement belief != ordinary weather prediction
use orients repentance, hope, fear and a life

LATER TERMS

language-game | grammar | form of life

D. Z. PHILLIPS

resisted simple non-cognitivist and reductionist labels

GAIN: prevents category mistakes and attends to context.

COST: FIDEISM / insulation if internal use excludes evidence and moral criticism.

REPLY: practices overlap; clarification does not itself validate truth.

BRAHMAN

real (sat), non-objectifiable, beyond ordinary predication

"whence words turn back" (Taittirīya 2.9)

ineffable / avācya; NOT neither-real-nor-unreal

MĀYĀ / WORLD-APPEARANCE

appears -> not sheer unreality

sublated by knowledge -> not ultimate reality

therefore different from real and unreal (sad-asad-vilakṣaṇa)

technically indeterminable (anirvacanīya)

TRAP: never collapse Brahman's ineffability into māyā's category-status.

NEGATION (neti neti; Brhadāraṇyaka 2.3.6) -> removes limiting predicates.

INDIRECT INDICATION (lakṣaṇā) -> intended import when literal sense fails.

PART-DISCARDING INDICATION (bhāga-tyāga-lakṣaṇā)

tat tvam asi -> discard incompatible connotations; retain consciousness.

OTHER BOUNDED STRATEGIES

Rāmānuja -> real auspicious attributes

Madhyamaka -> conventional meaning without intrinsic nature

Jain conditional predication (syādvāda) -> state the respect

Nyāya -> limited heuristic near univocity; not Scotus's doctrine

Mīmāṃsā -> injunction (vidhi), mantra, eternity of word (śabda-nityatva)

grammarians/Bhartṛhari -> classical sphaṭa; NOT a Mīmāṃsā doctrine.

AFFIRMATIVE ROUTE

symbol participates

-> practice draws subject in

-> bearer becomes transparent

-> SELF-EFFACEMENT

-> claimed immediacy / mysticism

WEST

Paul Ricoeur: symbol gives rise to thought; second naïveté

Pseudo-Dionysius: cataphatic -> apophatic -> silence

INDIA

symbol/image meditation (pratīka/pratimā upāsanā)

Māṇḍūkya Upaniṣad: Om A-U-M -> waking/dream/deep sleep

-> soundless fourth (amātra/turiya)

Tantra: mantra / yantra / maṇḍala internalised and dissolved

COMPARATIVE BRIDGE

Eliade: hierophany | Sufi allusive signs (ishārāt)

CONTROL: structured route, not logical guarantee.

- 1 ARREST
literalised symbol claims ultimacy -> idolatry / demonic
 - 2 CONSTITUTION
Steven Katz: inherited symbols shape experience from the start
 - 3 DELETION
Zen / neti neti advance through iconoclasm or subtraction
 - 4 NON-NECESSITY
ethics, inquiry (manana), attention and grace are other routes
 - 5 RETURN
mystic communicates again through culturally formed symbols
- VERDICT: normal and powerful route; neither necessary nor sufficient.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 21/25: The pluralism bridge

SEMANTICS -> epistemic access -> rival descriptions -> pluralism/exclusivism.

UNIVOCAL LITERALISM

direct commensurability -> contradiction -> exclusivist pressure

ANALOGY / SYMBOL / APOPHASIS

finite descriptions non-exhaustive -> pluralism intelligible

HICK

transcategorical Real + personae/impersonae -> semantic thesis

cost: vacuity; an empty Real cannot ground worship or discriminate traditions

INDIAN

Advaita: unqualified/qualified (nirguṇa/saguṇa)

Jainism: standpoint marked in assertion (syādvāda)

LIMIT: creator/no-creator and survival/no-survival remain hard contradictions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 22/25: Inter-thinker debate and standing criticisms

AQUINAS -> realism / indeterminacy

SCOTUS -> inference / anthropomorphism or onto-theology charge

MAIMONIDES -> transcendence / vacuity

TILLICH -> depth / vague referent and self-reference

AYER-FLEW -> evidence / over-restriction

BRAITHWAITE -> practice / reductionism

WITTGENSTEINIAN -> context / insulation

ADVAITA -> non-objectification / self-reference and silence

OPTIONAL HISTORY -> Radical Orthodoxy links Scotist univocity to secular metaphysics;
the genealogy is contested, not established history

STANDING CRITICISMS

anthropomorphism | agnosticism | fideism | reductionism | self-reference

RULE: state objection exactly where the theory's mechanism produces it.

2018 Q5(a) [10] secular vs religious use -> function/referent/self-involvement.
2018 Q7(b) [15] Braithwaite -> policy/stories + reductionism.
2018 Q8(c) [15] symbols mediate transcendent referent -> cultural/spatial/temporal.
2019 Q6(a) [20] whether AND how symbolism leads to mysticism -> route + negative case.
2020 Q8(a) [20] cognitive content -> spectrum + evidence + mixed verdict.
2021 Q8(a) [20] non-cognitive/Braithwaite -> family + distinct account + critique.
2021 Q8(c) [15] Tillich -> sign/symbol, participation, being-itself, caution.
CONTROL: exact wording; independent models; no official answer key.

2022 Q5(e) [10] "God exists" -> apply cognitive/non-cognitive directly.
2023 Q5(d) [10] Wittgenstein -> use/form of life + qualification.
2023 Q7(c) [15] Tillich -> complete mechanism + objection.
2024 Q5(e) [10] analogy -> dilemma + res/modus + Scotus.
2024 Q8(a) [20 = 10+10] -> distinction first; contradiction/Braithwaite second.
2025 Q5(b) [10] symbolic? -> yes-but reasons + justification.
2025 Q8(c) [15] Advaitic anirvacanīyatā -> māyā/Brahman + semantic operations.
CONTROL: obey printed marks split and named-thinker fidelity.

TRAPS

analogy != metaphor | symbol != sign | non-cognitive != meaningless
Ayer != Braithwaite != Hare != Wittgensteinian use
Tillich's being-itself exception is disputed
Scotus semantic != ontological univocity
Brahman ineffability != māyā's anirvacanīyatā
Mīmāṃsā's śabda-nīyatva != Bhartṛhari's sphoṭa

ANSWER SPINE

identify HOW/WHETHER -> define mechanism -> named evidence
-> explain what it proves -> strongest objection -> reply -> residual cost

CLAIM PARAGRAPH

claim -> text/thinker/example -> analysis -> qualification

QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

intelligible reference + apophatic humility + practical force
+ critical vulnerability = defensible mixed realism.